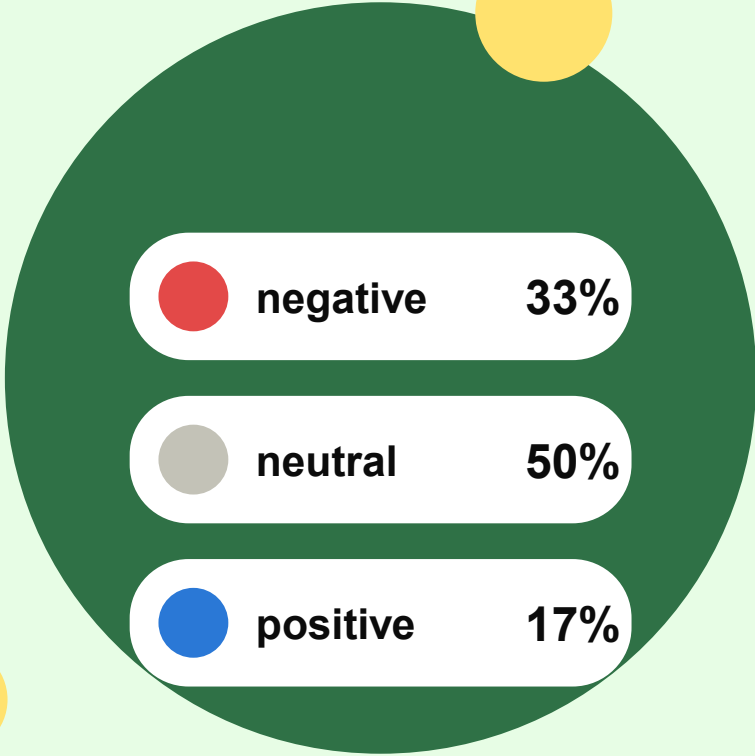
Live pulse of what developers say about AI coding tools

AI Coding Pulse

SDG 9: Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure

Benjamin van Teeseling and Lili Tárnok

Hackathon 6: Live Pulse



The user and the decision

Who

An engineering team lead at a small or medium software company (5 to 30 developers) who manages the tool budget.

Problem

AI coding tools change every few weeks and opinions are spread over hundreds of comments a day. Nobody has time to read them all.

Decision

Roll the tools out now, run a pilot, or wait.

1. **Steady or rising mood**
   A pilot is easier to justify
2. **Sudden dip**
   Open the comments and read why before spending money
3. **Few comments behind a point**
   Do not trust it yet

How it works

1

Hacker News

comments via the Algolia API

2

Filter

keeps comments about AI coding tools

3

cardiffnlp

pre-trained model: negative, neutral, positive

4

CSV on GitHub

one row per comment, with timestamp

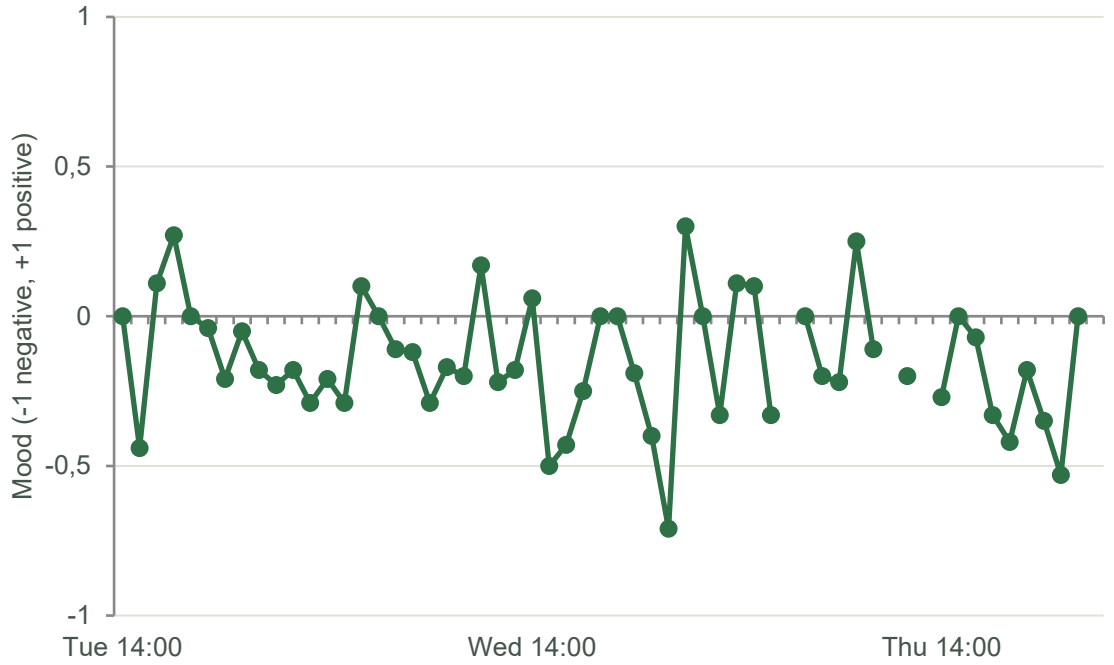
5

Dashboard

mood per hour or day

Runs without us: a GitHub Actions workflow runs every 15 minutes. GitHub's own schedule did not start on Tuesday, so a free cron-job.org timer triggers it. 664 comments over 55 hours so far.

The mood over time



664

comments collected

-0.16

overall mood (share positive minus share negative)

33 / 50 / 17

% negative / neutral / positive

The comments behind a dip

Wed 14 Oct, 22:00

-0.71

the lowest hour (14 comments)

- **10** negative
- **4** neutral
- **0** positive

Discouraged about hobby coding

“No pleasure really anymore, my hobbies were coding occasionally and there's no point to it. Anything I write will be outdone in 2 seconds by someone else.”

Distrust of vibe coding

“I'm hesitant to even use Linux due to vibe coding bleeding into the kernel.”

Confused by too many tools

“OpenAI has too many options that may confuse users. I don't know if I should use ChatGPT app or Codex CLI or Astra for development.”

How often is the model right?

35 / 50

cardiffnlp agrees with our labels (70%)

12 / 50

VADER word list agrees (24%)

Always answering neutral would score 54%.
VADER called 42 of 50 positive.

cardiffnlp against our hand labels (50 comments)

We said	Model: negative	Model: neutral	Model: positive
negative (15)	**10**	5	0
neutral (27)	3	**22**	2
positive (8)	0	5	**3**

Yellow = model and we agree. Labelled by hand by Lili without seeing the model's answers.

The failure that taught us most

The model plays it safe

10 of its 15 mistakes
were “neutral” where we saw an opinion.

It found only 3 of our 8
positive comments.

So the mood line probably under-reports opinions, especially mild or sarcastic ones.

Example: sarcasm

“That's the brilliant part! ... you just fire your existing dev teams, hire in 'AI-native' devs ... and try again!”

We said: **negative**

cardiffnlp said: **neutral**

VADER said: **positive**

What to remember

1

Who is in the data

Hacker News developers, not managers, students or people who do not post.

2

How reliable

About 70% right on our test, and weakest on sarcasm and mild opinions.

3

What not to do

Do not use it to judge individual commenters, or as the only basis for a decision.

One input next to a pilot and a talk with the team.